Westbrook School Committee

~ School Committee Meeting ~

Date: Wednesday, February 11, 2026
Time: 7:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 117 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1164172178
Packet: https://drive.google.com/file/d/16lYKEkCAv2Jl9qO0lRFKNnM1w84wRGk4/view (Google Drive, via westbrookschools.org)

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *The full committee (all seven members) was present; one student representative (Jamila Mohamed Ahmed) was present and delivered the student report. For complete context, nuance, and anything not covered, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Superintendent's Report

Tree Grant, FY25 Audit & New District-Run Pre-K Program [5:53]

Discussion Summary

Superintendent Dr. Peter Lancia announced a $15,000 Project Canopy grant (Maine Department of Agriculture, Conservation and Forestry) to replace ash trees lost to disease around the high school bus loop, alongside athletics and family-engagement updates and a kindergarten registration reminder for children turning five before October 15, 2026.

Assistant Superintendent of Operations and Finance Dr. Brian Mazjanis reported the FY25 financial audit found no significant findings and no material weaknesses, with three minor internal-control recommendations. The district's fund balance entering FY26 is approximately $900,000–$905,000, of which about $700,000 is already allocated to buy down the FY26 budget, leaving roughly $205,000 in margin.

Assistant Superintendent Dr. O'Donnell presented a new district-run Pre-K program: Westbrook has been accepted into “Cohort 3” of a state-mandated process assuming responsibility for three- and four-year-old early-childhood programming as Maine's Child Development Services (CDS) program winds down. The district will pause its partnership with Opportunity Alliance and open two district-managed Pre-K classrooms at Canal School, starting with four-year-olds only in year one; the state will reimburse special-education costs and the added seats increase the district's state per-pupil funding count (ED279).

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — informational presentations.

Action Items

None.

Chair / Student / Committee Reports

Joint Meeting Canceled & Student Report [18:33]

Discussion Summary

Chair Andrea Mancuso reported a positive capital-improvement-planning meeting with city finance staff, and announced the February 23 joint City Council/School Committee meeting has been canceled, replaced by informal staff-level meetings to maintain budget-season collaboration. She closed by thanking school staff for supporting the community through a challenging recent month, without specifying the underlying event on the record.

Student Representative Jamila Mohamed Ahmed reported on high school Spirit Week, WRVC's Career and Technical Education Month (308 program applications received as of February 9), Westbrook Middle School's Quarter 2 honor-roll assembly, and elementary-school updates from Canal, Saccarappa, and Congin.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — informational reports.

Action Items

None.

Facilities, Finance, Policy & Educational Programs Updates [26:47]

Discussion Summary

Facilities (Reed) toured Congin School, where solar panel installation is nearly complete; a possible summer bathroom renovation is under consideration but not confirmed. Finance (Poitras) reported healthy, on-track monthly financials and a preliminary (not guaranteed) $2.2 million increase in state subsidy (ED279), driven by multilingual-learner growth, special-education cost catch-up, transportation funding, and CTE funding changes; Westbrook's local share of education costs has risen to 52.3%, with the state share down to 47.7% this year.

Policy (Cavallaro) previewed upcoming work reworking employee/student harassment and discrimination policies to align with the Maine Civil Rights Act after related federal changes were rescinded, continued homework-policy review, and the cell-phone ad hoc committee regrouping to weigh a possible “bell-to-bell” cell phone ban. The transportation ad hoc committee is reviewing walking distances, late-bus protocols, and stop consolidation. Educational Programs (Rice) reported a draft 2026–27 school calendar going out for community survey feedback.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — informational reports.

Action Items

None.

New Business

12.1 & 12.2 — Bond Fund Reallocation & Canal School HVAC Renovation Grant [32:59]

Discussion Summary

Item 12.1 authorizes a request to City Council to reallocate remaining FY25 bond proceeds (originally $1.7 million for Canal School bathroom/vestibule work and $1.4 million for Westbrook High School bathroom renovation, both completed under budget) toward additional capital projects including Congin School bathroom

renovation. Item 12.2 accepts a Maine Department of Education School Revolving Renovation Fund grant of $426,445 to replace Canal School's HVAC system, with the district responsible for repaying roughly half the award. Both items were escalated from first approval to a combined first-and-final reading on the floor.

Key Decisions

✓ 12.1 approved 7–0 (first and final), moved by Katy Rice, seconded by Noreen Poitras.

✓ 12.2 approved 7–0 (first and final), moved by Erin Cavallaro, seconded by Noreen Poitras.

Action Items

None.

12.3–12.8 — Six School Department Policy Actions (Taken in the Aggregate) [35:35]

Discussion Summary

At Noreen Poitras's request, six policy items were read into the record and voted together: adopt Policy BID (School Committee Member Compensation, newly established under the Westbrook City Charter — see the January 14, 2026 summary for its compensation schedule); approve Policy EHB (Records Management), EHB–R2 (Records Retention Schedule), and EHB–R3 (School Records to be Transferred to Next Grade Level); and delete Policy EHB–L and EHB–LR (Litigation Hold and Litigation Hold Procedures). Unlike 12.1 and 12.2, these remained first approval only.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 7–0 as a bloc, moved by Noreen Poitras, seconded by Katy Rice.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was downloaded with Downie 4 and transcribed with speaker diarization using MacWhisper. Claude (Anthropic's AI) cross-checked names against the official School Committee roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the Chair) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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